Policy & Strategy Lab

Workbook 5: Evidence

Participant	
Name	
Case (problem statement)	
Decision-making role and decision	
Pod	

How to use this workbook

Each worksheet applies one day's anchor tool to your own case. Complete it during the session and finish it in your independent time. Keep earlier versions: revision is credited, so record what changed and why in the feedback box at the end of each worksheet. Tag every substantive claim in your Analyst's Ledger as fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

Competencies practised in this workbook: C5, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, I3, J3, J5.

Using AI tools. You may use AI tools to suggest structures, rival explanations or improvements to your writing. You may not use AI output as evidence. Every fact, figure, citation and description of an institution must come from a source you have checked.

Worksheet 5.1: Building the evidence register

Day 11: Finding and judging evidence. Anchor tool: Source reliability assessment.

Purpose. Assemble the published evidence your workplan needs, and judge how far each source can be trusted.

In brief.

- Each kind of source is good for some questions and poor for others.
- Judge a source by who made it, how, when, at what level and what it leaves out.
- Write each claim at the strength its evidence supports.
- Cite the original, verify every detail and never invent one.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur register entries: the 2016 rules (law, high); the city waste plan (official plan, medium, states intentions); ward returns (administrative, low to medium, self-reported); a state CAG audit of waste management (audit, high for its period).

Instructions.

1. Add at least six sources to your register, covering at least three types.
2. For each, record producer, method, period, level and limitations.
3. Rate reliability, with a reason.
4. Note which hypothesis each source supports or weakens.
5. Mark whether you checked the original and whether AI helped.

Evidence register

Citation (Chicago)	Type	Coverage: place, period, level	Reliability and reason	Hypothesis and direction	Verified? AI used?

Reflection.

1. Which source do you trust most, and would a sceptic agree?
2. What does your strongest source establish, and what does it only suggest?
3. Which hypothesis still has no good source?

My reflections

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ At least six sources.
- ☐ At least three types of source.
- ☐ Every rating has a reason.
- ☐ Every citation is checked against the original.

Hand in. Updated evidence register by the start of Day 12.

Before the next session. Read your two most important sources properly, including the methods section. Write three sentences on what each establishes and what it does not. About 50 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why

Worksheet 5.2: Data analysis

Day 12: What the numbers say. Anchor tool: Disaggregation and comparison in a spreadsheet.

Purpose. Find where your problem concentrates and what the numbers can, and cannot, support.

In brief.

- Disaggregate: averages hide where the problem lives.
- Say points or per cent, and check the denominator.
- Choose the chart for the comparison and label it honestly.
- Round to what the data can bear, and name what is missing.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur (illustrative): separation by ward group, last year and this year. Finding: a sharp rise in planned colonies, little change elsewhere, incomplete data for informal settlements. Limitation: ward returns are self-reported.

Instructions.

1. Find the dataset that bears most directly on your priority hypothesis.
2. Disaggregate it by place, group or time.
3. Produce three charts or tables, each with a title that states the finding.
4. Write three observations, two interpretations and one limitation.
5. Record each source in the evidence register.

Charts and tables

#	Title that states the finding	Data, year and source	What it shows	What it does not show

Observations and interpretations

Observation (what the numbers show)	Interpretation (what it might mean)	Limitation

Reflection.

1. Where does your problem concentrate: which place, group or period?
2. Which claim would a sceptic challenge first?
3. Did any number in your work imply more precision than the data can bear?

My reflections

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ Three charts or tables, each disaggregated or comparative.
- ☐ Titles state findings.
- ☐ Year and source on every chart.
- ☐ Limitations stated.
- ☐ No unsupported causal language.

Hand in. Worksheet 5.2 by the start of Day 13.

Before the next session. Finish your three charts. Ask your pod's evidence checker to review one chart for an honest scale and honest wording. About 50 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why

Worksheet 5.3: Comparative and qualitative evidence

Day 13: Experience and comparison. Anchor tool: Comparative case matrix.

Purpose. Learn from other places and from published accounts of people's experience, and judge what transfers to your case.

In brief.

- Published qualitative evidence reveals mechanisms and voices that numbers miss.
- A theme carries weight when independent sources agree.
- Ask what made an intervention work there, and whether those conditions exist here.
- Copy functions, not forms.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur compared with Indore, Pune and Ambikapur: the principle of paying for separated collection and partnering with organised waste pickers may transfer; Indore's scale of spending and sustained leadership may not.

Instructions.

1. Find two or three places that tackled a problem like yours, using published sources.
2. Fill the comparative matrix: what was done, what helped, what transfers.
3. Code at least three published qualitative sources into themes.
4. Mark each theme as supporting or weakening a hypothesis.
5. Add every source to the evidence register.

Comparative case matrix

Feature	Place 1	Place 2	Place 3
What was done			
What helped it work			
Evidence of results, and its source			
What transfers to your case			

Thematic notes

Theme	Sources (at least two)	Supports or weakens which hypothesis

Reflection.

1. Which success story is most tempting to copy, and what condition might be missing in your case?
2. Which of your themes rests on only one source?
3. Whose experience is still missing from your evidence?

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ Two or three comparison places.
- ☐ Conditions for success identified.
- ☐ Themes drawn from at least three sources.
- ☐ Every source in the register.

Hand in. Worksheet 5.3 by the start of Day 14.

Before the next session. Prepare for the red team: write your three strongest findings so far, each with its two best sources. About 50 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why